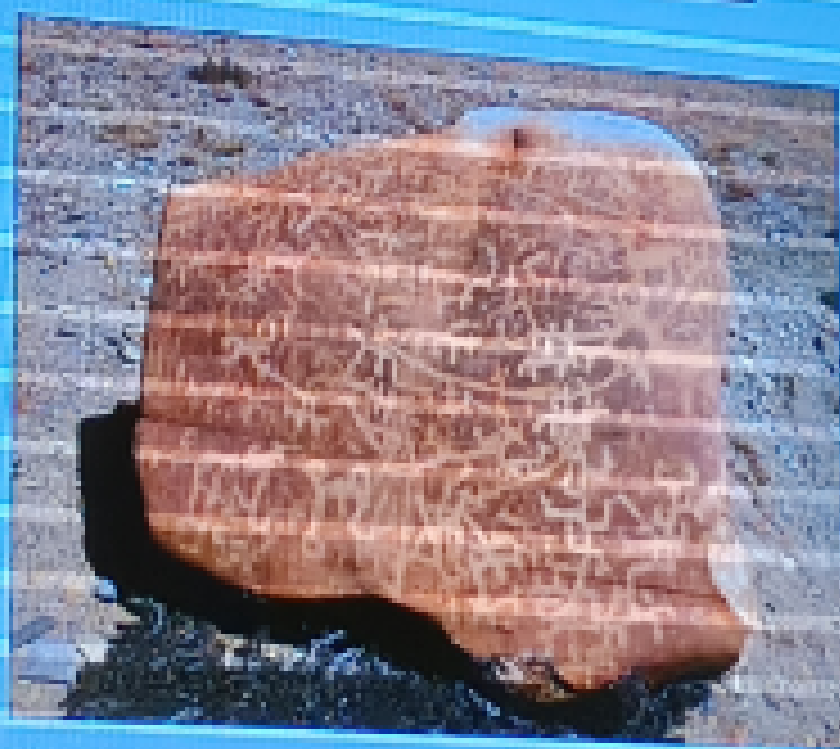
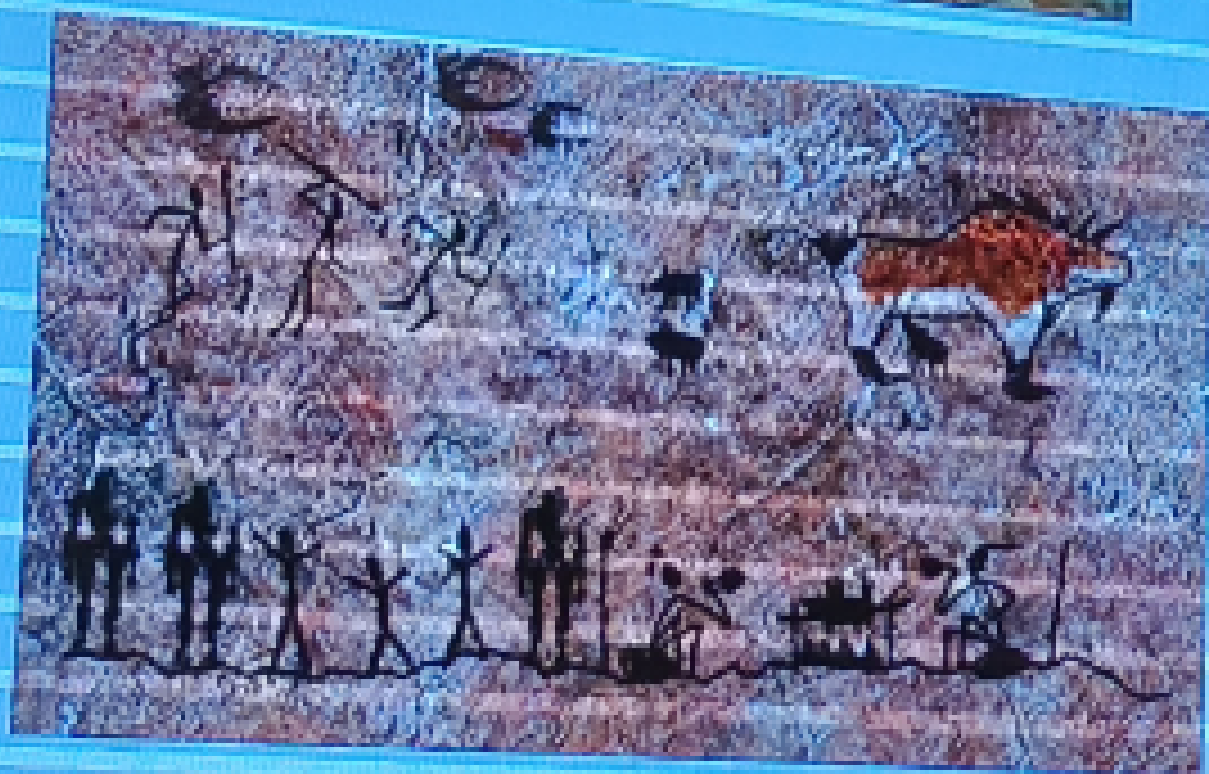
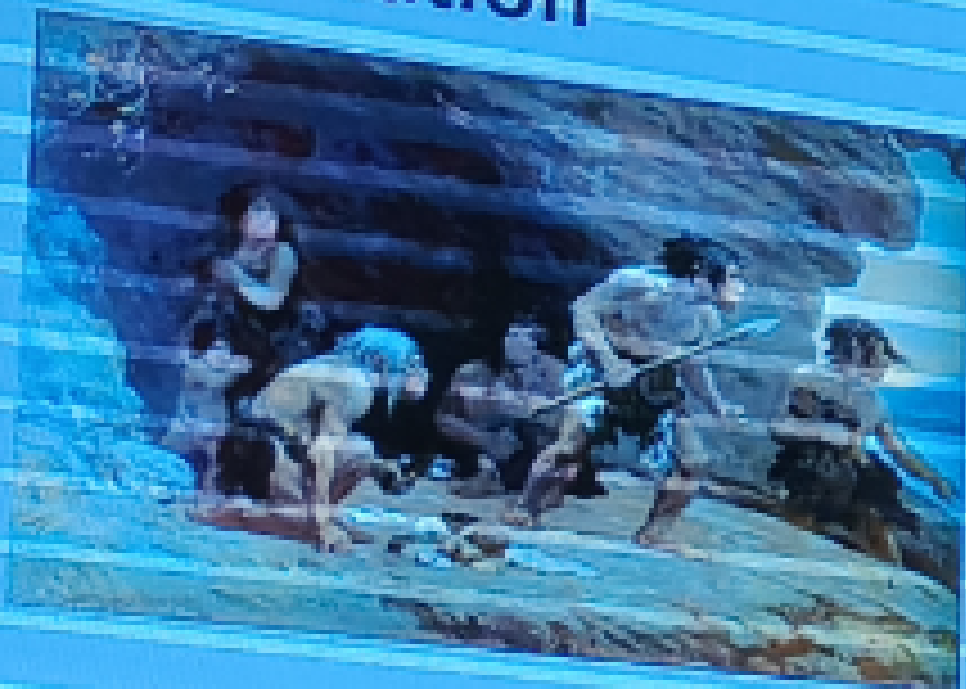


**Written Communication:
Final Points**

Good Communication

- Effective problem solving since the dawn of civilization



WRITERLY WRITING

The Erroneous Sentence: Some Common Mistakes

- a) Being the most spectacular event in the nation, newspapers were obligated to devote major coverage to the hurricane.

Errors: newspapers were not the most spectacular event

- b) He had arrive at his home town.

Error: Tense

- c) Either the physicians in this hospital or the chief administrator are going to have to make a decision.

Error: Subject-verb agreement

Complex Theoretical/Academic Writing

"But let there be no misunderstanding: it is not that a real man, the object of knowledge, philosophical reflection or technological intervention, has been substituted for the soul, the illusion of theologians. The man described for us, whom we are invited to free, is already in himself the effect of a subjection more profound than himself. A 'soul' inhabits him and brings him to existence, which is itself a factor in the mastery that power exercises over the body. The soul is the effect and instrument of a political anatomy; the soul is the prison of the body."

Michel Foucault in *Discipline and Punish* (1977).

Creative Writing

From Arundhati Roy's *The God of Small Things*

See the use of similes. Simile is the figure of speech involving the comparison of one thing with another of a different kind used to make a description more emphatic or vivid.

"Her face was pale and wrinkled as a dhobi's thumb from being in water for too long." (4)

"Still birds slid by on moving wires like unclaimed baggage at the airport." (8)

"History's smell. Like old roses on a breeze." (55)

See use of neologisms:

"getting-outedness"; "Bar Nowl"; "viable-dieable age"

Inconsistent Verb Tenses

(From Northern Illinois University's Writing Tutorial)

- In formal writing, it is important to keep verb tenses consistent so that readers can follow the progress of ideas and arguments easily.

Inconsistent Verb Tenses

(from Northern Illinois University's Writing Center)

- In formal writing, it is important to keep verb tenses consistent so that readers can follow the progress of ideas and arguments easily.
- In creative writing, verb tenses may be used inconsistently for effect, but in academic writing, it is important to use verb tenses consistently throughout a paper, carefully signaling any necessary shifts in tense.

Readerly Writing

- ✓ Simple and Precise
- ✓ Sticks to Rules of Grammar
- ✓ Chronological
- ✓ Without Contradictions
- ✓ Without complexity

Effective Formal Writing

Central to Good Communication (Writing)

- Sequencing of ideas:

- a) Collect ideas
- b) Know the existing conversation
- c) List of keywords
- d) Thesis statement
- e) Algorithmic progression of argument

- Grammar:

- a) Correct syntax
- b) Tenses
- c) Active and Passive Voice
- d) Modifiers

From Purdue University's Online Writing Lab

- Unnecessary or inconsistent shifts in tense can cause confusion.
- Generally, writers maintain one tense for the main discourse.
- [Writers] indicate changes in time frame by changing tense relative to the primary tense, which is usually either simple past or simple present.
- Even apparently non-narrative writing should employ verb tenses consistently and clearly.

Consistency and Elegance in Writing

- Just as sentences must be balanced, they must also be consistent.
- Errors in consistency involve verb and pronoun usage. For example, if a sentence begins in the past tense, it must stay in the past tense.
- Do not shift from one tense to another if the time frame for each action or state is the same. (Example: The instructor explains the diagram to students who asked questions during the lecture.) (From Purdue Online Writing Lab)
- Like tenses, pronouns need to be consistent in person and number
- A shift from the singular I to the plural we, for example, can leave the reader wondering just who is doing what in the sentence.

Incorrect Tenses

- Elizabeth Peabody was born in a school and thereafter felt destined to be a teacher. Her mother was a teacher and trains her daughters at her side. The academic life seems to suit Elizabeth, who thrived on the rigorous curriculum.
- **Was, felt, and thrived** are past tense; **trains** and **seems** are present tense. All of the action in the passage above occurred in the past, so all of the verbs there should be in the past tense.

Parallel Structure

- Parallel structure involves pairs and lists of words and phrases.
- Both items in a pair, and all items in a list need to follow the same grammatical pattern.
- If you're writing about your friend's favorite leisure activities, you wouldn't say, "Juan loves skating and to read."
- It sounds awkward because the items in the pair aren't the same grammatically.
- The first is a participle or verb tense (*skating*), and the second is an infinitive or a verb used as a noun, adjective or adverb (*to read*).
- You can see that one of the two needs to be changed in order to maintain parallel structure. You could change *skating* to *to skate*, or *to read* to *reading*.
- Either way, you'll get parallel structure.

- Examples of Parallelism

- ~~One of the best ways to prepare for a career in journalism is to become an informed citizen by reading a variety of newspapers, watching documentaries and televised news programs, and you should read books about world leaders, politics, and grassroots movements. No error.~~
- ~~This sentence offers a list of three things one can do to become an informed citizen: *reading*, *watching*, and *you should read*. Notice how the third item does not follow the same grammatical pattern as the first. It should begin with a verb in participial form, *reading*. *You should* is unnecessary and should be eliminated.~~
- ~~One of the best ways to prepare for a career in journalism is to become an informed citizen by reading a variety of newspapers, watching documentaries and televised news programs, and reading books about world leaders, politics, and grassroots movements.~~

Parallelism

- The more I read about deep sea fishing, the more it makes me want to get out there and try it. No error.
- In this example, the phrases after the words *the more I read* are not grammatical equivalents. *It makes me* should be matched with *I want to*.
- The more I read about deep sea fishing, the more I want to get out there and try it.

Passive Voice

- In the passive voice, the subject is acted upon.
- While there are occasions in which it's correct to use it, most sentences should be in the active voice.
- Passive constructions tend to be wordy or lack focus.

Compare these sentences:

Active: My friend asked for another helping.

Passive: Another helping was asked for by my friend.

Active: I misplaced my wallet.

Passive: My wallet was misplaced by me.

Active: The administration has selected three finalists for the open position.

Passive: Three finalists for the open position have been selected by the administration.

Note the simplicity and directness of the first sentence in each pair. The second sentences, written in the passive voice, are clunky and noticeably longer. With very few exceptions, sentences like these should be quickly eliminated; they're almost always wrong.

When to use passive voice?

(<https://advice.writing.utoronto.ca/revising/passive-voice/>)

In some sentences, passive voice can be perfectly acceptable. You might use it in the following cases:

The actor is unknown:

The cave paintings of Lascaux were made in the Upper Old Stone Age. [We don't know who made them.]

The actor is irrelevant:

An experimental solar power plant will be built in the Australian desert. [We are not interested in who is building it.]

You want to be vague about who is responsible:

Mistakes were made. [Common in bureaucratic writing!]

You are talking about a general truth:

Rules are made to be broken. [By whomever, whenever.]